
BRAVO COMPANY
COMMUNICATIONS DOMINATE WARFARE

DATA SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR COURSE

DS.02.03

GROUP POLICY

OVERVIEW

- GPO Overview
- Benefits of Group Policy
- Limitations of GPOs
- Best Practices
- Group Policy Settings

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Refer to your student handout for detailed list of your Terminal and Enabling learning objectives.

GPO OVERVIEW

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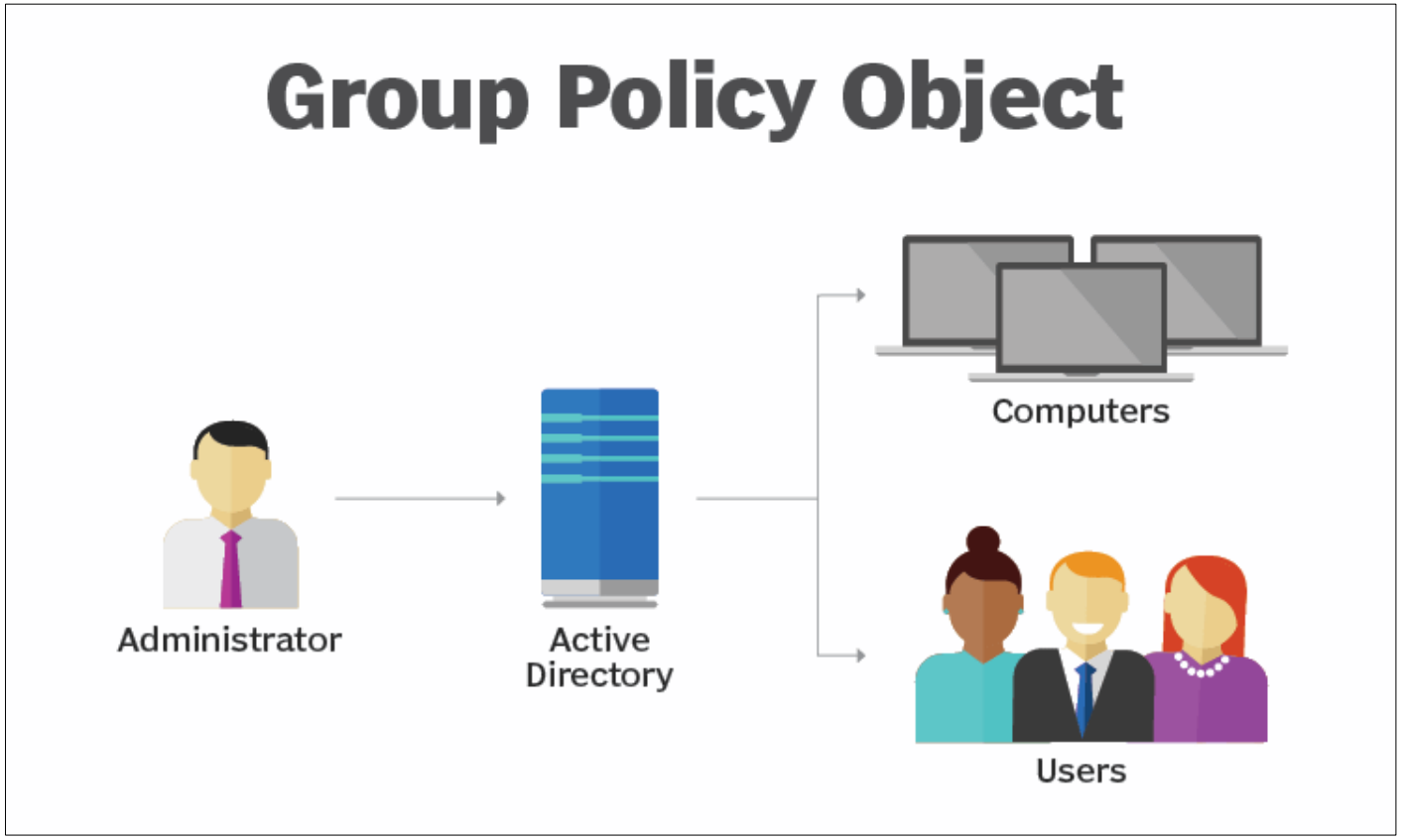
- ***Microsoft's Group Policy Object (GPO)***
  - Collection of Group Policy settings that defines what a system will look like and how it will behave for a defined group of users or machines

GPO OVERVIEW

- ***Microsoft's Group Policy Object (GPO)***
  - ***Types of GPOs (3)***
    - Local Group Policy Objects
      - Only apply to the local computer and to the users who log on to that computer.
      - When policy settings need to apply to a single Windows computer or user
    - Non-local Group Policy Objects
      - Have to apply to one or more Windows computers or users
      - apply to Windows computers or users once they're linked to Active Directory objects, such as sites, domains or organizational units
    - Starter Group Policy Objects
      - Templates for Group Policy settings

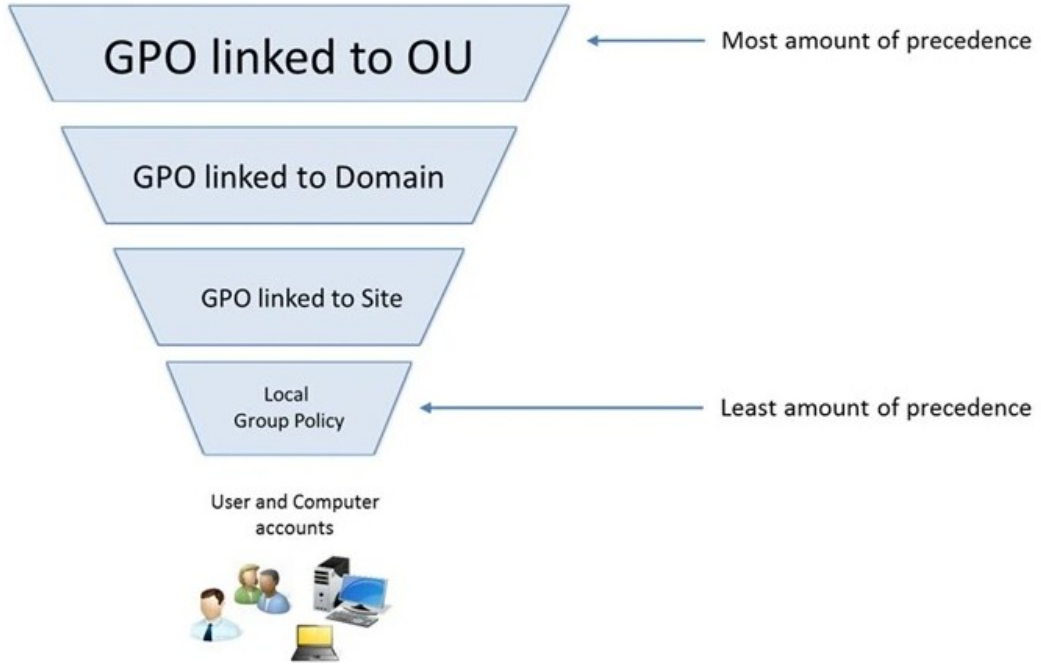
GPO OVERVIEW

- ***Microsoft's Group Policy Object (GPO)***



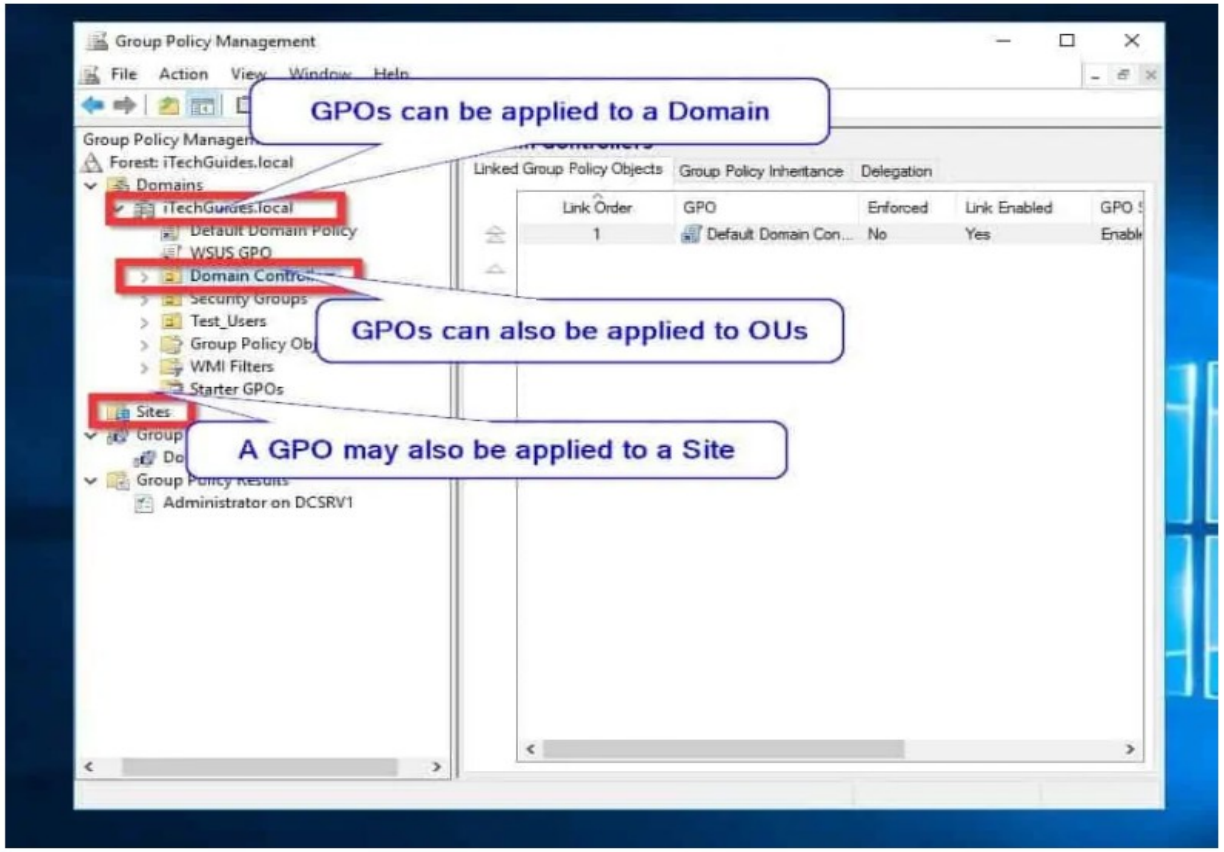
GPO OVERVIEW

- ***Processing order of GPOs***
  - This **processing order** is known as **LSDOU: Local, Site, Domain, Organization Unit**.



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BENEFITS OF GROUP POLICY

BENEFITS OF GROUP POLICY OBJECTS

- ***Benefits of Group Policy Objects***
  - Efficient management
    - Apply a standardized environment
    - Saving time on setup
  - Ease of administration
    - System administrators can deploy software, patches and other updates via GPO
  - Better password policy enforcement
    - Establish harder requirements for passwords to keep a company's network safe
  - Configuring folder redirection

LIMITATIONS OF GROUP POLICY

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- ***Limitations of Group Policy Objects***
  - They run sequentially
    - Can take a long time for users to log on if improperly configured
    - GPOs process actions one after another
  - Flexibility is limited
    - Can only be applied to users or computers
  - Limited triggers
    - GPOs can’t react to changes in environment, such as network disconnect or reconnect

LIMITATIONS OF GROUP POLICY

- ***Limitations of Group Policy Objects (Cont.)***
  - Difficult to maintain
    - No built-in search or filter option to find a specific setting within a GPO
    - Incorrect naming standards can create confusion
  - No Version Control
    - If an incorrect change is made, it's impossible to tell what the change was or who made it
    - Changes made to GPO settings aren't audited

BEST PRACTICES

BEST PRACTICES

- ***Some best practices for GPOs include:***
  - Create a well-designed organizational unit structure in Active Directory to simplify applying and troubleshooting Group Policy
  - Give GPOs descriptive names
  - Add comments to each GPO explaining why it was created
  - Don’t set GPOs at the domain level because they’ll be applied to all computer and user objects
  - Don’t disable a GPO. Rather, delete the link from an OU instead of disabling the GPO if you don’t want it to be applied

GROUP POLICY SETTINGS

GROUP POLICY SETTINGS

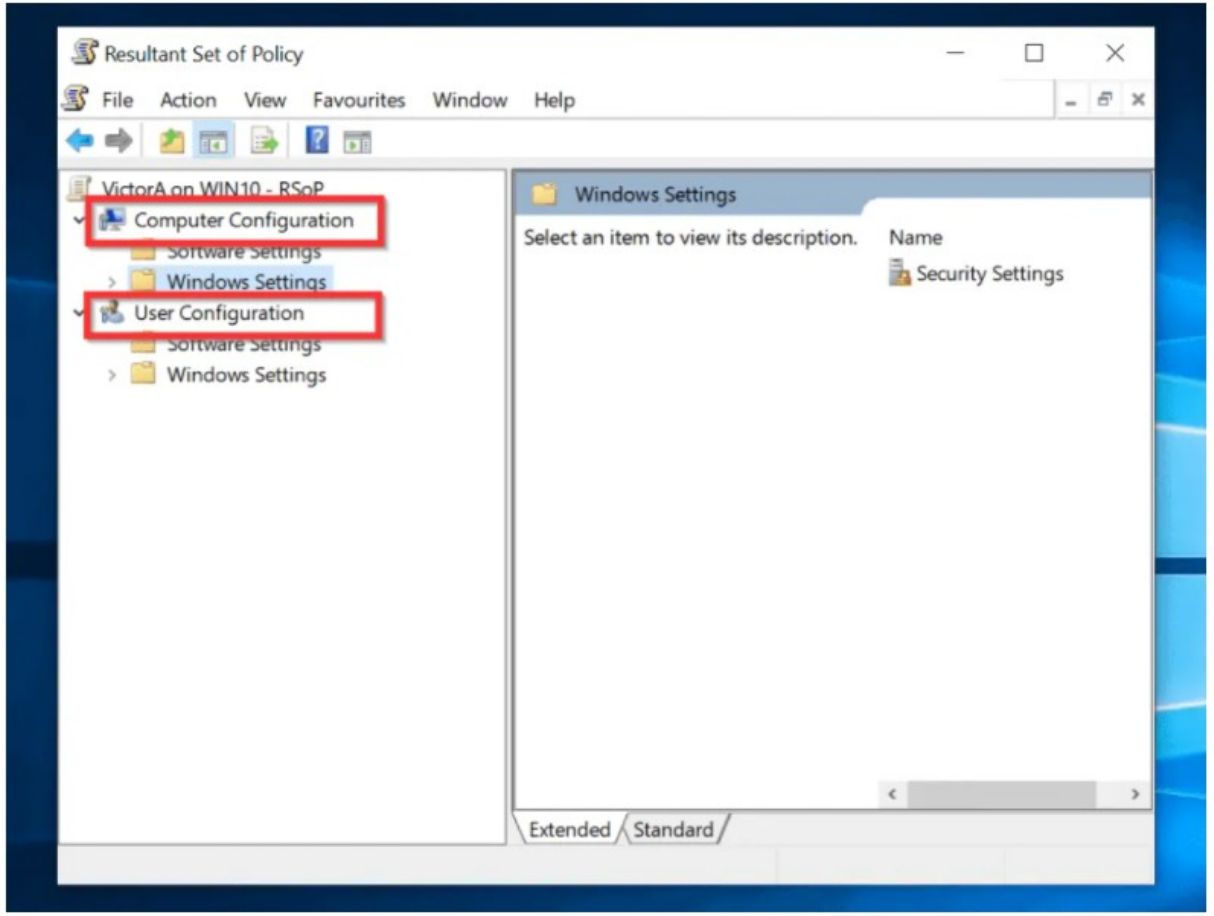
- ***How many policy settings are there?***
  - User Policy Settings
    - Specify capabilities and behaviors for interactively logged-on users
    - Can also affect different users who are logged on to the same computer
    - *Examples of such settings include the user's default location for saving documents, or the desktop background image for a user

GROUP POLICY SETTINGS

- ***How many policy settings are there?***
  - Computer Policy Settings
    - Specify capabilities and behaviors for individual computers, even when no users are logged on
    - Can also globally affect every user who logs on to the computer

    - *Examples include policy settings that enable a computer to host a web server, schedule automated disk backups of the computer, or specify a standard web home page for all users of the computer.

GROUP POLICY SETTINGS



SUMMARY

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